

Fourth Suit Forcing New Minor Forcing Help Suit Game Try

FSF : Suppose the partnership has already mentioned three suits, and the player who is next to bid wants to make a forcing bid but has no bid that is really descriptive of his hand. He just bids the fourth suit (whether he has it or not). This asks partner to further describe her hand.

NMF : Similar to FSF, this is Responder's second bid after she makes a suit response to partner's suit opening and Opener then bids Notrump. Bidding a previously unbid (New) minor suit asks for further description.

HSGT : When the bidding starts 1Major - 2Major, Opener can invite to game by bidding 3Major. A more descriptive invitation is to bid a different suit; this is also an invitation to game but asks partner to pay particular attention to whether he can "Help" in that suit.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these three conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead:  6

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4 
Declarer: East
Lead:  3

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4 
Declarer: South
Lead:  J

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4 
Declarer: West
Lead:  K

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead:  K

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 6 2
 ♥ 9 8 2
 ♦ A 10 5 3
 ♣ J 5

♠ A 10 5

♥ 10 4

♦ K Q 7 4

♣ A 8 6 3



♠ K 4

♥ K 6 5 3

♦ 8 6 2

♣ Q 9 7 4

♠ Q J 8 3

♥ A Q J 7

♦ J 9

♣ K 10 2

SOUTH has no reason to consider New Minor Forcing with this hand.

NORTH does not have four ♥s or he would have already supported, and he does not have four ♠s or he would not have bid 1NT.

So SOUTH should bid the Notrump game.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♦6			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 6 4
♥ K Q 9 7 4
♦ 4
♣ A J 6 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ J 10

♦ K 10 8 5 3 2

♣ 9 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 9 7 2

♥ 8 5

♦ A 9 6

♣ Q 10 4

♠ 8 3

♥ A 6 3 2

♦ Q J 7

♣ K 8 7 3

EAST might well bid 3NT at his second turn, and this may turn out to be the final contract anyway.

But it doesn't hurt to bid 2♦ (Fourth Suit Forcing) just to see if WEST happens to have three ♠s. She does, so 4♠ becomes the better game.

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	1♠	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			
4♠ by East			
Lead: ♠3			

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10
♥ 6 3 2
♦ 10 8 7
♣ K J 10 7 6

♠ A K 7 6 3

♥ K 10 8 4

♦ K 4

♣ 5 2



♠ Q 9 4 2

♥ A 5

♦ J 6 5 3 2

♣ Q 9

♠ 8 5

♥ Q J 9 7

♦ A Q 9

♣ A 8 4 3

SOUTH isn't strong enough to make a Reverse bid of 2♥ at his second turn.

NORTH uses the 2♦ (NMF) bid to ask SOUTH for further description. SOUTH should first show a 4-card ♥ suit, and next show 3-card ♠ support.

Change SOUTH's ♥9 to the ♠9 and the contract would be 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Pass	1♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♠J			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 10 7

♥ 7 6 5

♦ 3

♣ A K 8 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10 3

♦ K Q J 6

♣ 10 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 4 2

♥ 8

♦ 8 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 9 7

♠ 8 5

♥ K Q 9 4 2

♦ A 10 9

♣ J 5 2

WEST's 3♥ bid is a Help Suit Game Try.

EAST barely had enough strength to respond in the first place, but revaluing the hand, (and particularly the singleton ♥), makes it worth a raise to game.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by West

Lead: ♦K

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 4 2
♥ J 8 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ 8 7 5 4 2

♠ A J 7 5

♥ K 6

♦ 8 7 4

♣ A J 10 3



♠ Q 9 8 6 3

♥ Q 10

♦ J 10 9 3

♣ K Q

♠ K 10

♥ A 9 7 5 4

♦ K Q 6 2

♣ 9 6

NORTH has no reason to consider Fourth Suit
Forcing with this hand.

SOUTH does not have four ♠s or he would have
already supported.

So NORTH should bid the Notrump game.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♣K			